

"Oh, Brother Cook," exclaimed the inspector, on seeing the previously baked beans, fifty gallons strong, leisurely sitting on the heated back of the stove where they had been since Monday. "That is a bad place for those beans. They should have been in a cool place for keeping." He sampled them. "Sour!" he exclaimed. "Sour!" sighed the brother, as he tasted them himself. They gazed vacantly at each other for a moment. They both felt stupidly guilty. They both thought of the same baseball phrase, "---three men on bases, - Casey struck out!"

Their guardian angels must have smiled, for each blamed himself rather than the other. "Wait." exclaimed one of them with a gleam of hope, "Saleratus sweetens sour milk, if not too far gone. Let us try it on the beans." They boiled a sample quantity adding a pinch of saleratus (simple baking powder). The unintended experiment, with the magic powder coming to the rescue, had made the beans a credit for a king's banquet. Such at least was the general verdict that night.

"THE INSPECTOR HIMSELF"

THE RECIPE FOR THE BEANS

1. Wash well and soak overnight in plenty of water.
2. Boil about 10 minutes in cold water, until outside skin breaks when blown upon. Skim. (Added by hand in one copy - They get soft enough by long baking.)
3. Put a layer of salt pork or a portion of drippings in bottom of earthen pot, and alternately pour in beans and salt port. Earthen Pot by all means preferred.
4. N.B. molasses etc for coloring spoils the taste of baked beans.
5. Add salt to taste, and a little saleratus.
6. Bake in moderate oven from 3 to 4 hours, or until they become a rich brown color.
7. Sour kraut, pickled beets, or mustard pickles may be served as a relish with beans.

(Inspector) Father Solanus